

Empowering Karnataka's Sustainable Future: KREDL's Pioneering Role in Renewable Energy



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Karnataka Renewable Energy Development Limited (KREDL), established in 1996, plays a pivotal role in shaping Karnataka's green development narrative. As the nodal agency for renewable energy, KREDL is not only advancing the state's energy goals but also accelerating a broader sustainable development agenda that integrates environmental stewardship, social equity, and economic resilience.

Under the able leadership of Energy Minister K.J. George, Karnataka today ranks among India's top five states in renewable energy capacity—third in wind and fifth in solar. This status is the product of progressive policies and KREDL's proactive leadership in translating policy into ground-level impact. Through policies like the Renewable Energy Policy (2022–2027) and early solar and wind development initiatives, KREDL is helping reduce the state's carbon footprint while transitioning towards a low-emission economy.

As per Karnataka's Resource Adequacy Plan, KREDL targets 39 GW of new wind and solar projects with colocated 6000/2 MWhr of battery storage by 2034–35. These projects not only stabilize the grid and ensure energy security but also displace fossil-fuel dependence, contributing directly to climate action and clean energy goals under the UN Sustainable Development Goals (SDGs), especially SDG 7 (Affordable and Clean Energy) and SDG 13 (Climate Action).

KREDL's implementation of the PM-KUSUM scheme

demonstrates how clean energy can drive inclusive rural development. The proposed deployment of 40,000 off-grid solar irrigation pumps, supported by an enhanced 50% state subsidy, directly improves agricultural productivity and reduces diesel usage—benefiting both farmer incomes (SDG 1 and SDG 2) and environmental health (SDG 12).

Innovative projects like the 2 MW solar + 4.5 MWhr BESS pilot at Pavagada, the upcoming 100 MW solar + 100 MWhr BESS plant at Kalaburagi and 250 MW solar + 1100 MWhr BESS at Pavagada showcase Karnataka's readiness to embrace next-generation energy solutions. These hybrid projects ensure round-the-clock clean power, a critical requirement for decarbonizing urban and industrial sectors. In turn, they support sustainable urbanization (SDG 11) and innovation (SDG 9).

Equally important are the large-scale infrastructure projects, such as the 300 MW augmentation of Pavagada Solar Park and the planned Ryapte Renewable Energy Park (2 GW solar with 1 GWh BESS). These projects support economic development through land leasing models that benefit local communities, while boosting regional employment and supporting Karnataka's vision of decentralized growth. These integrated benefits reinforce SDG 8 (Decent Work and Economic Growth) and SDG 10 (Reduced Inequalities).

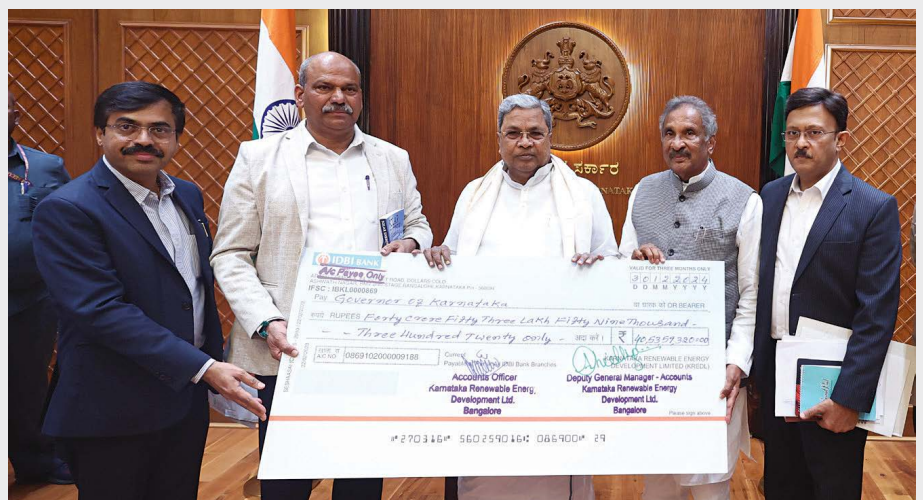
KREDL's proposed pilot project in green hydrogen, canal-top solar, and agrivoltaics illustrate a future-forward approach that integrates energy with land, water, and food systems—further supporting sustainable agriculture (SDG 2), water conservation

(SDG 6), and innovation ecosystems (SDG 9). These projects reduce pressure on natural resources and enable multifunctional land use.

No sustainable development strategy is complete without human capital. KREDL's Skill Development Centres and Surya Mitra training programs have already trained 150 youth, achieving a 95% placement rate. Its ongoing internship programs and incubation centre collaborations with UNSW, Australia and IIM Bangalore, reflect deep investment in education (SDG 4) and entrepreneurship (SDG 8). By skilling youth in clean energy, KREDL is not just creating jobs—it's creating a workforce for the green economy.

Recognition from national bodies underscores the impact of KREDL's work. Recently, Karnataka topped the charts for adding the highest wind capacity in the year 2024–25 among all states of India. KREDL was also awarded first prize in the State Designated Agency (Group-I) category at the National Energy Conservation Awards (NECA) for 2023, and second prize for 2024. Karnataka shined at the RE-Invest 2024 as a top-performing wind energy state. These awards reflect KREDL's effectiveness in delivering results and its alignment with national and global sustainability benchmarks.

Through a system-based approach to sustainable development, KREDL is integrating clean energy, inclusive growth, innovation, and institutional excellence—positioning Karnataka not only as a leader in renewable energy, but also as a model state demonstrating how green power can drive a resilient, equitable, and sustainable future.



Energy Minister K.J. George and KREDL handed over a ₹40.53 crore dividend cheque for FY 2023–24 to Chief Minister Siddaramaiah at Vidhana Soudha.